

# THE FLORIDA CONSIGLIERE

## Jeb Bush, The Miami Contraband, The 2000 Election Purges & The Architecture of the Privatized State

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Classification: Declassified Political Statecraft Audit • Subject: The Recarey Affair, ChoicePoint Voter Purges & The 2016 Collapse

**FORENSIC INVESTIGATIVE DIRECTIVE:** Within the political division of labor of the Bush family, **John Ellis "Jeb" Bush (1953–present)** was long designated as the family's true intellectual heir and national standard-bearer. Settling in South Florida during the height of the Cold War Caribbean conflicts, Jeb Bush operated as the essential commercial and political bridge connecting the Washington national security apparatus (directed by his father, Vice President and DCI George H.W. Bush) to the anti-Castro Cuban exile elite, real estate syndicates, and covert fundraising pipelines in Miami. As a two-term Governor of Florida (1999–2007), he transformed the state into a laboratory for radical institutional privatization—pioneering school voucher siphons, private prison expansion, and aggressive executive overrides of the judiciary—while managing the controversial 2000 election voter purge that placed his brother in the Oval Office. Despite amassing an unprecedented \$150 million political war-chest for the 2016 presidential primaries, his campaign suffered a catastrophic collapse when confronted by modern populist realignment. This dossier examines the corporate files, state archives, and financial records detailing the operational career of Florida's 43rd Governor.

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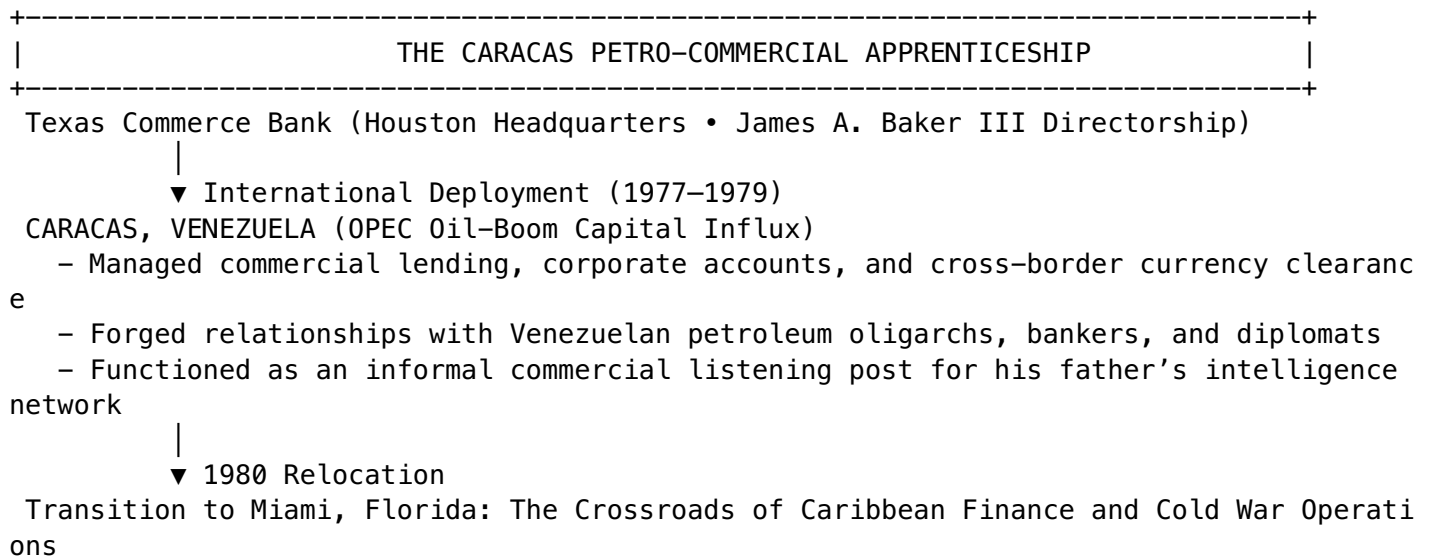
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## 1. THE VENEZUELAN APPRENTICESHIP: PETRODOLLARS (1977–1979)

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Unlike his older brother George W. Bush, who pursued the domestic oil boom in West Texas, John Ellis "Jeb" Bush positioned himself early in the international sphere. Graduating from the University of Texas at Austin with a degree in Latin American Studies in 1974, Bush married Mexican-born **Columba Garnica Gallo**, whom he had met in 1970 while teaching English in León, Guanajuato.

In 1977, Bush joined **Texas Commerce Bank**, an institution deeply embedded in the Bush-Baker political alliance, founded by the family of James A. Baker III. Rather than remaining in Houston, Bush was dispatched to Caracas, Venezuela, as a branch manager during the peak of the OPEC oil windfall.



The Caracas years provided Bush with fluent Spanish, deep familiarity with Latin American financial flight capital, and international commercial contacts that proved foundational when he relocated to Miami in 1980 to manage his father's vice-presidential campaign efforts in South Florida.

## 2. THE MIAMI REAL ESTATE AXIS: ARMANDO CODINA & CANF

Arriving in Miami in 1980 with limited personal capital, Bush entered the booming commercial real estate sector by partnering with Cuban-American developer **Armando Codina** to form the **Codina Bush Group**.

Codina was a prominent figure within the politically influential Cuban exile community, closely allied with **Jorge Mas Canosa**, founder of the **Cuban American National Foundation (CANF)**. Under Codina's tutelage and capitalized by Cuban exile business networks, Bush became an affluent commercial leasing broker, securing deals with major corporations, defense contractors, and state agencies seeking access to South Florida.

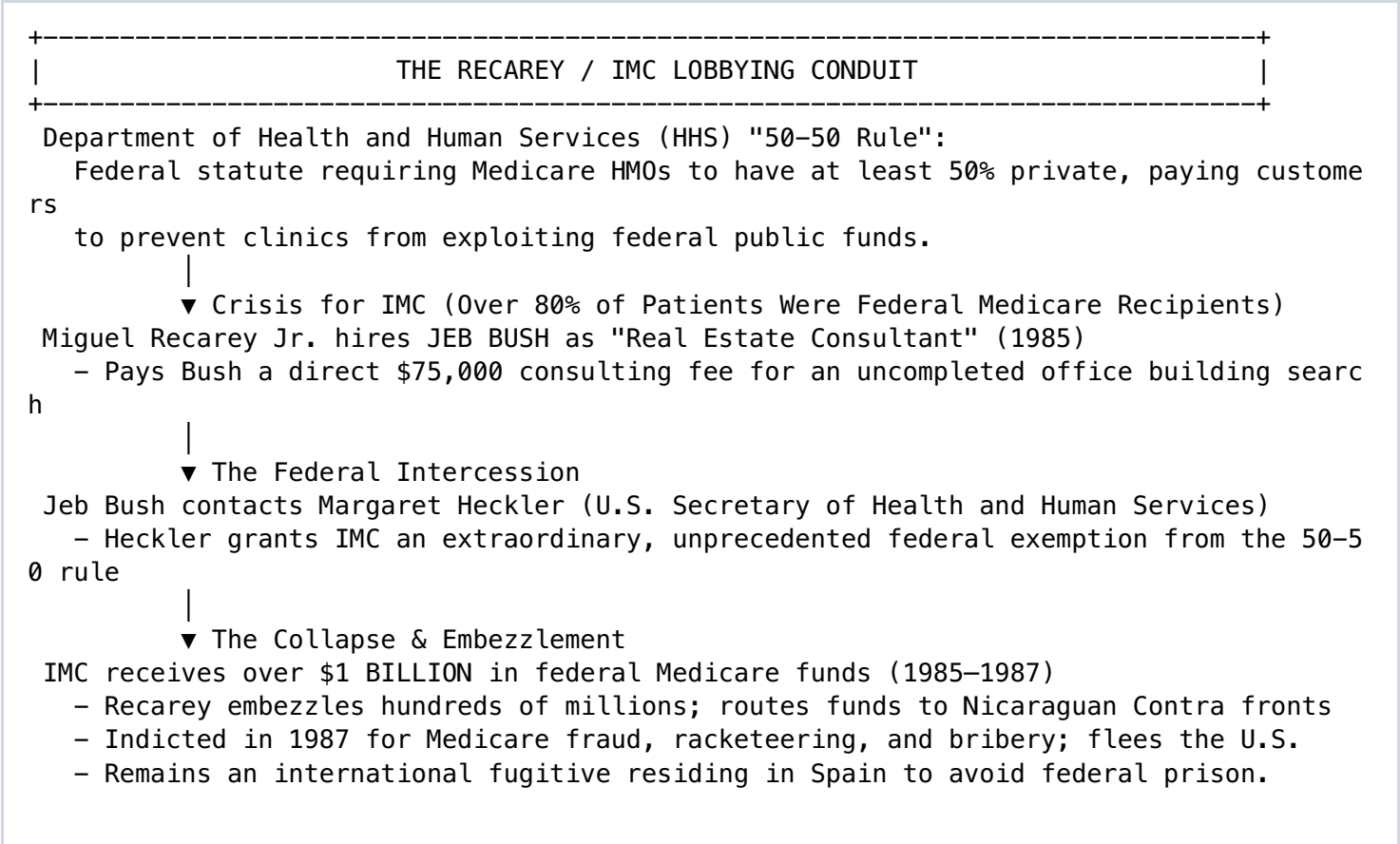
| <b>Commercial Asset / Enterprise</b>         | <b>Operational Partner</b>   | <b>Strategic / Political Nexus</b>                                             | <b>Financial Windfall</b>                                            |
|----------------------------------------------|------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Codina Bush Group</b>                     | Armando Codina               | Downtown Miami office towers, institutional real estate development            | Bush received 40% equity share with zero initial capital investment. |
| <b>Museum Tower (Downtown Miami)</b>         | Codina / Federal GSA Leases  | Secured long-term federal agency office leases (including DEA and US Marshals) | Multi-million-dollar leasing commissions; lucrative building equity. |
| <b>Maserati / Foreign Import Concessions</b> | South Florida Auto Importers | Commercial trade facilitation across the Caribbean basin                       | Direct executive stipends while serving in state trade roles.        |

## **The Interlocking Anti-Castro Conduit**

The partnership went beyond commercial property. The Codina Bush Group served as an influential political headquarters in Dade County. Jeb Bush served as the bridge between his father's office in the White House and the anti-Castro leadership, securing federal grants, political access, and international backing for hardline exile initiatives throughout the Reagan-Bush administration.

### 3. THE RECAREY AFFAIR: INTERNATIONAL MEDICAL CENTERS

The most controversial episode of Jeb Bush's Miami business career involved **Miguel Recarey Jr.**, a Cuban-American healthcare entrepreneur with historical ties to the CIA's anti-Castro plots and mob associate Santo Trafficante Jr. Recarey was the founder and chief executive of **International Medical Centers (IMC)**, which grew into the largest Medicare health maintenance organization (HMO) in the United States.



House Subcommittee on Human Resources and Intergovernmental Relations

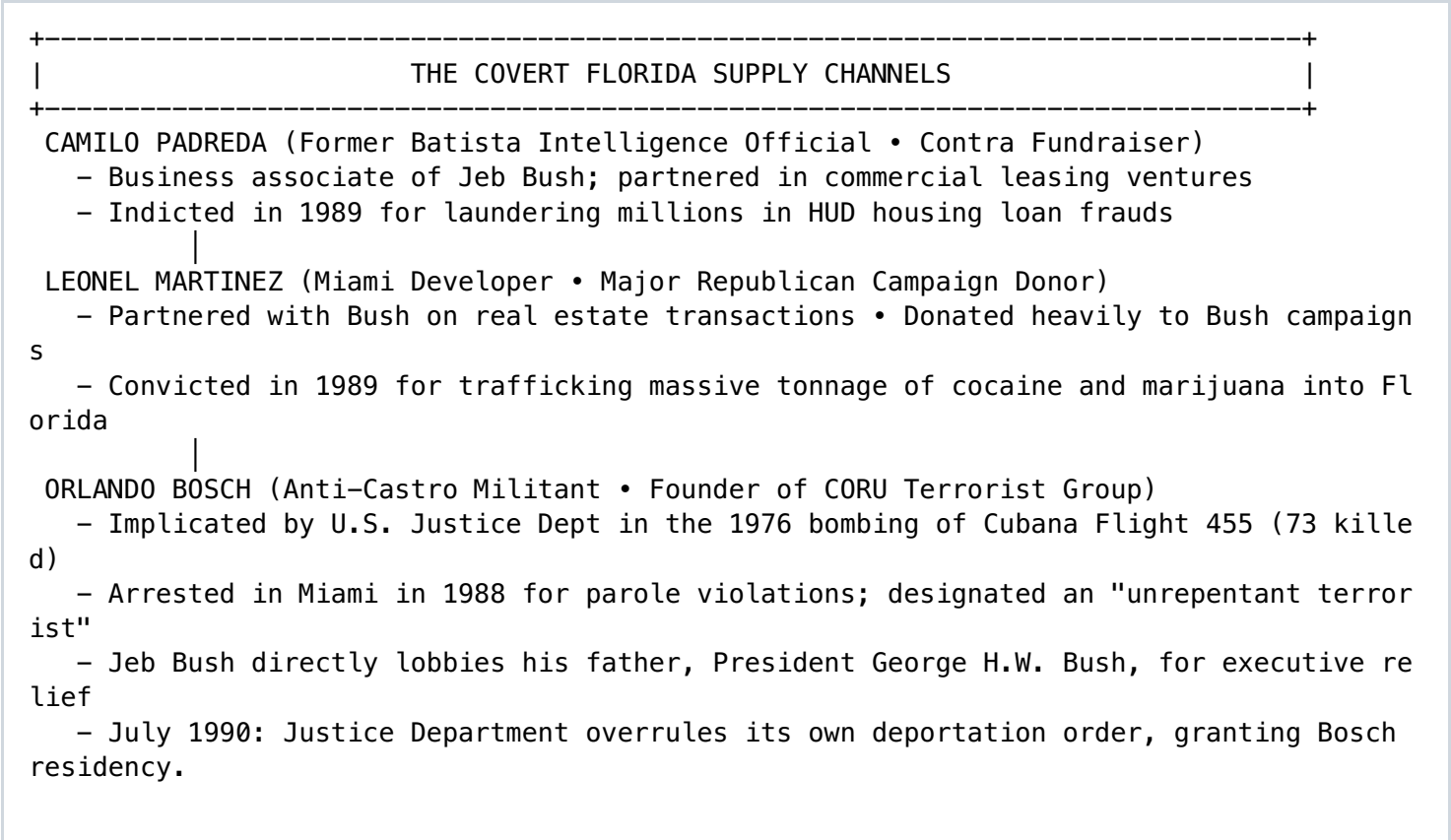
U.S. House of Representatives • Congressional Investigation into IMC Fraud (1988)

*"The special treatment accorded to International Medical Centers by federal regulators was unprecedented. Millions of taxpayer dollars were looted because the Department of Health and Human Services repeatedly failed to enforce statutory standards following direct lobbying intercessions from high-level political figures, including the Vice President's son, Jeb Bush."*

**Congressional Record:** When questioned under oath by investigators, federal regulators confirmed that calls from Jeb Bush created a dynamic where standard audits of Recarey's operations were discouraged or delayed.

## 4. CONTRA LOGISTICS & THE ORLANDO BOSCH PARDON

During the 1980s, South Florida functioned as the primary logistical base for the **Nicaraguan Contras**, covertly coordinated through the National Security Council and the CIA. Jeb Bush's commercial relationships routinely intersected with figures operating inside this covert network.



### The Orlando Bosch Rehabilitation

The campaign to grant residency to **Orlando Bosch** highlighted the Bush family's alliance with the militant anti-Castro faction in Miami. Acting as campaign manager for Ileana Ros-Lehtinen's 1989 congressional race, Jeb Bush made Bosch's release a primary issue for exile voters, demonstrating that the family's ideological loyalties took precedence over federal counter-terrorism policy.

## 5. THE IDEOLOGICAL VANGUARD: 1994 DEFEAT & THE "HEAD ON A STICK"

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Appointed Florida Secretary of Commerce in 1987 by Governor Bob Martinez, Bush stepped down in 1988 to work on his father's presidential campaign, laying the groundwork for his own electoral career. In 1994, he entered the Florida gubernatorial race against popular incumbent Democrat **Lawton Chiles**.

Running as an aggressive, self-described "head-banging conservative," Bush advocated for dismantling public welfare, slashing government payrolls, and dramatically increasing the rate of state executions:

### The 1994 Gubernatorial Debate Controversy

Orlando, Florida • October 1994

During a televised gubernatorial debate, when asked by a moderator what he would do for Florida's African American community, Bush responded: "**Probably very little.**"

While Bush attempted to clarify that he meant he would not offer targeted social programs, the comment alienated Black voters and moderate suburbanites, allowing Lawton Chiles to win a narrow, 64,000-vote victory.

## The Foundation for Florida's Future & Strategic Recalibration

Following his 1994 defeat, Bush established the **Foundation for Florida's Future**, a policy think-tank funded by corporate donors. He revised his public persona: adopting a softer, policy-focused demeanor focused on education reform, while maintaining his underlying commitment to privatization, school vouchers, and deregulation.

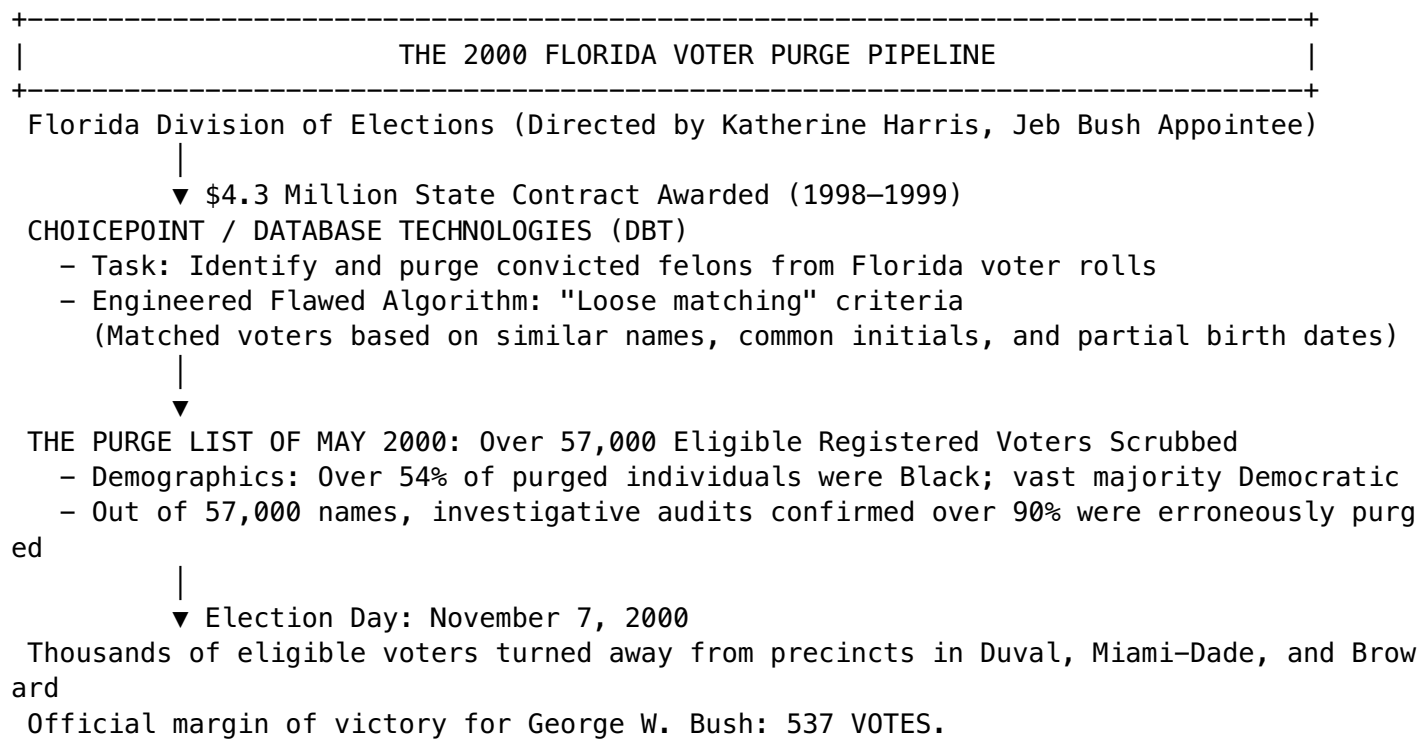
In 1998, running against Lieutenant Governor Buddy MacKay, Bush captured the governorship with 55% of the vote, securing executive power over Florida ahead of the 2000 presidential election.

## 6. THE 2000 RECOUNT: CHOICEPOINT & RECUSAL THEATER

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The November 2000 presidential election between Governor George W. Bush and Vice President Al Gore came down to the state of Florida, where Jeb Bush held executive power.

While Governor Bush publicly recused himself from the State Board of Canvassers to project an appearance of neutrality, his political and legal network worked to secure the state's electoral votes for his brother.



**The Structural Execution of Bush v. Gore**

Behind the scenes, Jeb Bush coordinated with campaign manager Karl Rove and legal strategist James A. Baker III. While state police checkpoints slowed turnout in minority districts, Secretary of State Katherine Harris shut down ongoing hand recounts, certifying George W. Bush as the winner and paving the way for the Supreme Court's 5–4 decision in *Bush v. Gore*.



# 7. THE PRIVATIZED STATE: VOUCHERS & THE CORRECTIONS INDUSTRY

During his two terms as Governor (1999–2007), Bush executed an aggressive structural privatization of state government functions, transforming Florida into a model for corporate governance:

| Public Sector Function     | The Bush Administration "Reform"                                                             | Primary Corporate Beneficiary                                          | Long-Term Systemic Consequence                                                                                                     |
|----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Public Primary Education   | The "A+ Plan" & Opportunity Vouchers; standardized testing quotas.                           | Private religious schools, for-profit charter chains, Pearson Testing. | Siphoned tax revenues from under-resourced public school districts; Florida Supreme Court ruled vouchers unconstitutional in 2006. |
| State Prison System        | Massive expansion of private, for-profit detention contracts.                                | Corrections Corporation of America (CCA / CoreCivic), GEO Group.       | Private prison industry became major political donor to Florida GOP; high recidivism.                                              |
| State Civil Service System | "Service First" Law (2001): Stripped 16,000 civil servants of civil service job protections. | Executive branch political appointees.                                 | Dismantled non-partisan tenure protections; permitted wholesale firing of state staff.                                             |
| State Child Welfare (DCF)  | Outsourced child protection services to private contractor network.                          | Private child-care agencies and regional nonprofits.                   | Resulted in systemic scandals involving thousands of unaccounted-for children (e.g., the Rilya Wilson case).                       |

## The Enron Pension Disaster

Under Bush’s tenure as trustee of the Florida State Board of Administration (which oversaw the state pension fund), Florida continued purchasing shares of **Enron Corporation** even as the energy firm’s financial irregularities became public in late 2001. Enron’s CEO, Kenneth Lay, was a close friend, major donor, and key fundraiser for the Bush family. When Enron collapsed into bankruptcy, Florida’s state pension fund lost over **\$334 million in state retirement assets**.

# 8. EXECUTIVE AUTOCRACY: SCHIAVO, "STAND YOUR GROUND"

In the later years of his governorship, Bush increasingly deployed executive power to override the judiciary, local prosecutors, and established medical standards to appeal to religious conservative factions:

| THE DUAL EXECUTIVE OVERREACH PATHWAYS                                                                                                                                        |  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|
| 1. THE TERRI SCHIAVO CRUSADE (2003–2005):                                                                                                                                    |  |
| – Patient in irreversible persistent vegetative state since 1990; husband sought removal of feeding tube in accordance with medical findings and court rulings.              |  |
| – Bush pushed the Florida Legislature to pass "Terri's Law" (2003), empowering the Governor to personally override state court decisions and re-insert the feeding tube.     |  |
| – Florida Supreme Court struck down "Terri's Law" as a gross violation of the Separation of Powers; Bush attempted to deploy state police to seize Schiavo from her hospice. |  |
| 2. THE 2005 "STAND YOUR GROUND" LAW:                                                                                                                                         |  |
| – First state statute in the nation eliminating the common-law duty to retreat in public.                                                                                    |  |
| – Drafted in consultation with the National Rifle Association (NRA).                                                                                                         |  |
| – Established broad immunity from prosecution for deadly force, leading to a measurable escalation in homicides, culminating in the 2012 killing of Trayvon Martin.          |  |

## 9. WALL STREET PATRONAGE: LEHMAN & EXCELIN ED

Term-limited out of office in January 2007, Bush capitalized on his political connections. Rather than returning to real estate, he became a senior paid advisor to **Lehman Brothers**, earning over **\$1.3 million annually** for opening doors to foreign wealth funds and sovereign balance sheets right up until the firm's collapse in September 2008.

Following Lehman's collapse, he was retained by **Barclays**, while serving on the corporate boards of Tenet Healthcare, forestry giant Rayonier, and sanitation conglomerate Swisher Hygiene.

### The Foundation for Excellence in Education (ExcelinEd)

501(c)(3) Policy Network • Founded: 2008 by  
Jeb Bush

Bush established **ExcelinEd** to promote his Florida education policies nationally, including digital learning mandates, Common Core testing, and private school voucher legislation.

**Corporate Alignment:** The foundation was funded by major corporate donors—including Pearson, Amplify, Microsoft, and the Walton Family Foundation. Internal emails revealed that ExcelinEd drafted state legislation, coordinated with corporate lobbyists, and pushed state education departments to adopt digital curriculum packages produced by its donors.

## 10. THE \$150M IMPLOSION: "RIGHT TO RISE" & "PLEASE CLAP"

In December 2014, Jeb Bush announced his intention to explore a presidential run, positioned by the Republican establishment as the inevitable 2016 nominee. His political action committee, **Right to Rise**, shattered fundraising records, collecting over **\$118 million** in six months from Wall Street banks, private equity executives, defense contractors, and longtime family donors.

## THE 2015–2016 DYNASTIC IMPLOSION TIMELINE

June 2015: Bush formally launches presidential campaign in Miami

▼ Total Capital Raised: \$155 MILLION (Highest Super PAC war-chest in history)

## The Arrival of Donald J. Trump:

- Labels Bush "Low Energy Jeb," branding him the symbol of a failed establishment
- Attacks the family legacy directly: denouncing the 2003 Iraq War, the economic collapse of 2008, and the corporate donor-driven lobbying networks of Washington

### ▼ The Debate Humiliations & Public Disconnect

- December 2015: Debate clashes where Bush struggles to defend foreign policy
- February 2016 (New Hampshire): Delivers speech to a silent room, culminating in: "Please clap." – Capturing the disconnect between dynastic entitlement and voters.

## ▼ The Electoral Demolition

- Iowa Caucus: 2.8% of the vote (6th place)
- New Hampshire: 11.0% (4th place)
- South Carolina (Feb 20, 2016): Finishes 4th with 7.8%, despite heavy family campaigning

Feb 20, 2016: JEB BUSH SUSPENDS CAMPAIGN • The Dynastic Blueprint Exhausted  
Over \$130 million spent to win a total of four delegates – \$32.5 million per delegate.

## The Historical Assessment

The collapse of Jeb Bush's 2016 campaign marked the end of the Bush family's four-decade hold on the national political landscape. The political machine engineered by Prescott Bush, expanded by George H.W. Bush, and weaponized by George W. Bush proved ineffective when confronted by populist voter realignments. The family's donor-heavy, establishment model was decisively rejected by the electorate.

## Forensic Audit Checklist: State-Level Dynastic Power

- [ ] **Audit State Procurement for Exile/Covert Networks:** Cross-reference commercial leasing, state construction concessions, and export-import licensing with known intelligence and geopolitical proxy networks.
- [ ] **Scrutinize Federal Regulatory Waivers:** Track private corporate lobbying interventions (e.g., HHS Medicare rules) made by executive family members to detect improper regulatory exemptions.
- [ ] **Analyze Voter Roll Database Scrub Algorithms:** Audit private data vendor contracts (e.g., ChoicePoint/DBT) for biased matching criteria that disproportionately disenfranchise protected demographic classes.
- [ ] **Inspect Public Education Voucher Funnels:** Trace how state voucher programs divert public tax revenues to private, for-profit curriculum and testing corporations that fund executive political foundations.
- [ ] **Track Corporate Pension Investments in Connected Donors:** Audit state pension portfolios to identify risky holdings purchased in firms run by major political contributors (e.g., Enron).
- [ ] **Examine Executive Preemption of the Judiciary:** Document instances where gubernatorial executive orders override constitutional separation of powers (e.g., the Terri Schiavo interventions).
- [ ] **Audit Super PAC Expenditure Velocity:** Trace how large, non-regulated campaign war-chests (e.g., Right to Rise) are spent on political consultancy networks despite widespread grassroots rejection.